5 Intergroup trust and contact in transition

A social representations perspective on the Cyprus conflict

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The chapter discusses intergroup trust and its relation to intergroup contact from the perspective of intergroup relations originally initiated by Allport (1954) and recently developed in the context of Social Identity Theory. However, this chapter will argue that the theory of social representations can enrich the classic approach on contact by introducing a historical and cultural analysis. After situating the Cyprus issue in its historical context I present an analysis of present identity positions, within each community, as perspectives on intergroup relations that canalise the past–present–future transition and discuss how intergroup trust can be conceptualised in relation to contact from this perspective.

The contact hypothesis: from the reduction of prejudice to the promotion of trust

Trust and distrust retain close conceptual and empirical links with both intergroup contact and prejudice. Allport's (1954) seminal work on prejudice in *The Nature of Prejudice* was widely hailed for its theoretical inclusiveness as he "weaved historical, economic, sociological, and psychological perspectives together into coherent themes and explanations across the book" (Dovidio *et al.*, 2005, p. 13). He saw intergroup contact as a situational and socio-cultural factor that could lead to the reduction of prejudice only in situations marked by four key conditions: equal group status within the situation; common goals; intergroup cooperation; and the support of authorities, law, or custom. More recent work in the field of intergroup relations has set up to study when and how contact works towards the reduction of prejudice (Hewstone & Brown, 1986; Pettigrew, 1998; Tausch *et al.*, 2010), revealing the variables that mediate the effect of contact on prejudice like the reduction of threats, intergroup anxiety (Stephan & Stephan, 1985) and a host of other variables. Research appeared exploring the effects of contact not only on prejudice but also on trust. The recent emphasis on intergroup trust is premised on the identification of the lack of empirical research on intergroup trust in areas of intergroup conflict and the importance of trust for the political process of reconciliation in post-conflict societies and it is thus to be welcomed as a positive development (Tam *et al.*, 2009).

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However, such models are often depicted as describing universal processes and isolate the variables tested from the particular meaning and significance of such variables in each socio-historical context. Furthermore, such model testing often relies on self-reported accounts or opinions which can be discrepant from action.

In the case of trust one can additionally identify a major weakness relating to the epistemological bases of its conceptualisation. Trust is often defined in this paradigm as "a positive bias in the processing of imperfect information about the partner's intentions" (Yamagishi & Yamagishi, 1994, p.136) and implies the expectation that others will not exploit one's vulnerability and the belief that others will attempt to cooperate (Kramer & Carnevale, 2001). Such intergroup trust implies some form of risk taking on the part of the trusting partner as it allows individuals to accept the risk of being vulnerable and to make conciliatory initiatives to the other party with some degree of assurance that they will not be exploited (Tam *et al.*, 2009).

However, definitions of trust drawing on such cognitive-rationalist models imply that trust is a property of the individual, and as such strip intergroup trust from its relational, historical and socio-cultural nature. So one crucial question that emerges here is whether individual differences in prejudice and trust are individual characteristics or instead internally consistent political ideologies, socially validated justifications of social inequalities, conflict or separation that can be shared by many people in a single society.

One prominent response in social psychology to this problem has been Social Identity Theory (SIT) (Tajfel & Turner, 1979) with its emphasis on group level processes as qualitatively distinct from individual level processes on the basic premise that the root of the problem of prejudice and distrust lies in categorisation. However, the SIT solution to the problem of methodological individualism is questionable because categorisation and social comparison do not exhaust the complexities and particularities of the historical and socio-cultural context of intergroup conflict, a critique that might apply more to the followers of SIT and less to Tajfel himself (Reicher & Hopkins, 2001; Marková *et al.*, 2008). For sure, the proposed motivational basis of SIT as a quest for high self-esteem through categorisation reduces social dynamics of change and identification to the individual. As Duveen (2001) convincingly argued, to start from the motive for high self-esteem to understand issues of identity is, from a genetic point of view, to start from the wrong place since a person is born into a thinking society that is already structured by social representations that furnish positions of identity. A person is positioned first by others as a social subject of a category and then internalises an identity to become an independent agent in the field of identity by projecting expectations of identity on others and resisting him/herself being positioned by others (see Psaltis & Duveen, 2006, 2007; Duveen, 2001). Not only does SIT overemphasise the process of identification over the process of *being identified by others* but it also fails to examine the *historically changing content* of identities, thus providing an impoverished sense of the socio-cultural and historical nature of issues of identity and prejudice.

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To achieve the paradigmatic shift in understanding the contextually situated nature of intergroup relations an epistemological framework is required that moves from the individualist and binary subject–object epistemologies to systemic triadic epistemologies (Moscovici, 1972; Zittoun *et al.*, 2007; Psaltis, 2005b) sensitive to genetic change of the socially constructed forms of representation, and the articulation of different levels of analysis (intra-personal, inter-personal, positional/intergroup and ideological/social representational) (Doise, 1986).

By adopting the triangular social psychological outlook of *subject–object–other* proposed by Moscovici (1972) the way is paved to explore the role of the dynamics of contact as *social interaction* and *communication* as part of the process of the social construction and genetic change of social representations. This emphasis on communication based on the triangular epistemology (cf. Orfali, 2000; Marková, 2003) was a central characteristic of both of Moscovici's theories of innovation in social influence (Moscovici, 1976, 1980) and social representations (Moscovici, 1984).

This paradigmatic shift will allow the opening of the 'black-box' of contact and categorisation that can be achieved through the study of microgenesis, ontogenesis and sociogenesis (Lloyd & Duveen, 1990) of social representations of varying forms of social identity (e.g. gender, ethnic, and national). This shift entails the reconceptualisation of the notions of contact and trust as discussed in mainstream contact and social identity theory.

Contact and trust will need to be explored as social representations. This entails their study both as a set of ideas and values on the one hand and as a set of practices on the other hand. Such values, ideas and practices are in a constant process of change through microgenetic, ontogenetic and sociogenetic processes. Trust will need to be seen as a relational concept and its links with the past–present and future of identities and contact need to be clarified. This is one way of overcoming thethe narrow focus of mainstream contact theory that endangers the ecological validity of contact theory and risks making it inapplicable to 'real world' situations (Durrheim & Dixon, 2005).

In what follows I will present a piece of research exploring the links between contact, trust, identities and other variables touching upon the quality of intergroup relations between Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots in Cyprus. Understanding of the present state of intergroup relations in Cyprus and the research presented demands a short historical framing of the Cyprus issue.

Intercommunal relations between Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots and the Cyprus issue: the historical background

Cyprus history is often depicted as a long succession of different rulers: Assyrian, Persian, Alexander the Great, Ptolemy of Egypt, Roman, Byzantines, Arabs, Crusaders, Lusignans, and Venetians. In 1571 Cyprus became part of the Ottoman Empire until it changed hands when administration was ceded to the British in 1878. After the First World War the British officially annexed Cyprus to the

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British Empire. According to the Official Census of Population of 1946 during the British Colonial period Greek Cypriots (henceforth GCs) comprised 80% of the population and Turkish Cypriots (henceforth TCs) 18%. The TCs were living, in minority numbers in the towns, in 105 purely Turkish Cypriot villages and in many mixed villages peacefully together for hundreds of years until the ethno-nationalist projects of the nineteenth and twentieth century of Greece and then Turkey were imported in Cyprus and caused the first intercommunal frictions, which broke out in 1957 and 1958. This was during the 1955–1959 anti-colonial struggle of GCs organised by EOKA, Εθνική Οργάνωση Κυπρίων Αγωνιστών (National Organisation of Cypriot Fighters), for liberation from the British and union with Greece, and the corresponding nationalist struggle of the leadership of TCs organised by TMT, Türk Mukavemet Teskilati (Turkish Resistance Organisation), for *taksim*, that is, the partition of Cyprus into two parts, one Greek and one Turkish (Attalides, 1979).

In 1960 the Republic of Cyprus was established as an independent bi-communal partnership state under a consociational constitution. Such a constitution was then seen by both communities as a temporary solution and the first step towards *enosis* (union with Greece) for GCs and *taksim* (partition of the island) for TCs. The Greek Cypriots' feeling was that the constitutional privileges accorded to the Turkish community, which was seen as a minority, were unfair and that they should only be guaranteed minority rights in the Republic of Cyprus; the Turkish Cypriots claimed that these were the just rights of a co-founding community. Soon, particular provisions relating to taxes and the autonomy of municipalities brought frictions between the two communities and a gridlock in the normal functioning of the state (Markides, 1977). In December 1963 intercommunal conflict erupted after the President of the Republic of Cyprus, Archbishop Makarios, proposed constitutional amendments to improve the functionality of the Cypriot state that were perceived by the TC leadership as a move that removed almost all their rightful claims as co-founders of the Republic and that was aiming at downgrading their community to the status of a minority. The armed conflicts that ensued led to the withdrawal of Turkish Cypriot ministers from the Cabinet.

The fighting between extremists from both sides lasted throughout 1963 and 1964. TCs began retreating from isolated rural areas and villages into enclaves that took about 3–4% of the land. According to the 1973 Census, the number of mixed villages was further reduced to 42 (see Table 1 for the diminishing number of mixed

Table 1 Ethnic population segregation from 1891 to 1970 (adapted from Patrick, 1976)

Year	*Mixed villages*	*GC villages*	*TC villages*	*No. of villages*	*% mixed*	*% GC*	*% TC*
1891	346	342	114	802	43	43	14
1931	252	358	84	694	36	52	12
1960	114	392	117	623	18	63	19
1970	48	444	11	503	10	88	2

Notes: GC Greek Cypriot; TC Turkish Cypriot.

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villages in time). After 1967 intercommunal strife ceased and Makarios started to turn away from union with Greece towards a more independent policy resisting the dictates of the Greek military junta that came to power in 1967 in Athens.

In 1974 a Coup was staged by the right wing extremist group EOKA-B[1] in Cyprus and the Greek Junta against the president, Archbishop Makarios, in order to bring about union followed by a Turkish military offensive. As a result all the GCs (160,000) living in the areas in northern Cyprus now occupied by the Turkish military forces were forced to flee to the south, and all the TCs have segregated in the north in 37% of the land of the island.

The two communities became geographically completely segregated and have remained segregated in the past 36 years. In 1983 the TC leadership established a breakaway state in the northern part of Cyprus internationally recognised only by Turkey. UN resolutions condemned the establishment as an illegal act and the European Court of Human Rights has described the self-styled 'Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus' breakaway state as 'a local subordinate administration to Turkey'.

On 23 April 2003 the Turkish Cypriot leader announced that he would unilaterally partially lift the travel restrictions that had been enforced since the Turkish intervention/invasion of 1974,[2] and which had prevented Greek Cypriots from crossing into the north part of Cyprus and Turkish Cypriots from crossing into the south. One year later, in April 2004, Greek Cypriots rejected a UN sponsored plan to reunite Cyprus under a federal state by 76% whilst Turkish Cypriots accepted it with 65%.[3] Since then renewed efforts to solve the Cyprus issue are on-going.

The importance of intergroup contact in Cyprus

This brief historical framing of the Cyprus issue makes clear that the opening of crossing checkpoints on 23 April 2003 was a unique situation of rupture (Zittoun *et al.*, 2003) of the taken for granted of the no-contact *status quo* that continued for 30 years. Any meaningful analysis of contact in Cyprus needs to keep this historical fact in perspective. People had to face the very tangible dilemma 'to cross or not to cross?' (see Demetriou, 2006, 2007). They had to master the unfamiliar situation of deciding whether they would be visiting or not their houses, now occupied by other people or troops, or places of highly symbolic value and nostalgia that they had left under life-threatening conditions. Crossing the checkpoints and coming into contact with people now occupying a home one left 30 years ago under life-threatening conditions can be an emotionally tormenting but also an ideologically laden and filled with tensions experience that creates questions of the capacity of intergroup contact to lead to the reduction of prejudice and the promotion of trust under these unique conditions. In addition, the meaning that each community gives to crossing and contact can possibly moderate the relationship between contact and trust by influencing the sociogenetic processes of the social representations of contact and trust in each community.

From a socioculturally sensitive perspective that recognises both the relational and ideologically laden nature of contact we can advance our understanding of the

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relationship between contact and trust and the ideological barriers to the beneficial effects of contact in the reduction of prejudice in important ways. However, special care should be taken not to fall into the Charybdis of sociological holism whilst trying to avoid the Scylla of methodological individualism, by falling into an essentialist view of community and culture (Duveen, 2007; Raudsepp and Wagner, Chapter 6 in the present volume). Unravelling the variety of ideological positions around the issue of contact can raise the following question: in what ways can representations circulating in communities and cultures constrain the opportunities for contact and their effect? I intend to explore this question by taking as a case study the study of representations of contact between Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots in Cyprus and their relation to trust.

A social representations approach to intergroup contact and trust: recovering the complexity of the socio-cultural context of intergroup contact

The social representations approach avoids both methodological individualism and the reification of the notion of culture (see Duveen, 2007; Psaltis & Duveen, 2006, 2007). For Serge Moscovici (1976, 1984, 1998, 2000) a social representation is:

> a system of values, ideas and practices with a twofold function: first to establish an order which will enable individuals to orient themselves in their material and social world and to master it; and secondly, to enable communication to take place among the members of a community by providing them with a code for social exchange and a code for naming and classifying unambiguously the various aspects of their world and their individual and group history.
> (Moscovici, 1973, p. xii)

A social psychologist interested in contact reading this oft cited definition of social representations would immediately see that 'communication' and 'social exchange' have a crucial role in this theory. Still, intergroup contact has only rarely been examined from the social representations perspective although the ethnographic work of Jodelet (1989) on contact between the mentally ill and the villagers in Ainay-le-Châteaux is an exemplary work despite the limitation of studying only the perspective of the villagers and not also the mentally ill. The work of Jodelet, as well as the seminal work of Moscovici (1961) in the second part of his book on psychoanalysis, showed that definitions of social representations in terms of consensus are insufficient. More than consensual beliefs, social representations are organising principles, acting as a social meta-system that organises the thinking of the person (Doise *et al.*, 1993).

In places where communities are geographically divided across ethnic lines for almost half a century, as is the case in Cyprus with the existence of linguistic and religious differences, different social representations are expected to have evolved in the two communities. This was often done through a planned and politically driven manipulation of the educational system and particularly history teaching as

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a political weapon in both communities (Papadakis, 1993, 1997, 2008; Makriyianni & Psaltis, 2007; Makriyianni, 2006). Within each community the struggle for power and ideological influence was always related to the formation of diverse interest groups and political parties, which created diversified dynamics and ideological tensions (Marková, 2000, 2003) with their own versions of the past and collective memory (Wertsch, 1997, 2002; Wertsch and Batiashvili, Chapter 2 in the present volume).These ideological tensions are often related to different policies, political and micro-political agendas, strategies and tactics how to resolve the Cyprus issue that valorise contact and trust in varied ways.

There is no doubt that both Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots share some reference points in relation to the Cyprus issue that make communication between them possible (e.g. a past of intercommunal conflict, the presence of foreign troops in Cyprus, the existence of displaced people, the existence of an internationally recognised and an unrecognised state in Cyprus). Social representations furnish varying positions of identity (Duveen, 2001; Psaltis & Duveen, 2006, 2007; Duveen & Psaltis, 2008) and expectations of relating with the other. Such positions may refer to varying meanings of the Cyprus issue in the *past*, paint the *present* quality of varying emotions, feelings of trust or distrust and threat in relation to the *other* and project possible *futures*. It is thus possible to identify different organising principles for each position within each community and trust or distrust can actually be discussed as an organising principle of intergroup relations and contact. Thinking and contact are governed by trust and distrust, acting as normative regulations that control, verify, and direct cognitive operations (Doise *et al.*, 1993) in the *past–present–future* transition.

Method

One major methodological problem that social psychologists face in the study of social representations using questionnaires is, according to Doise *et al.* (1993), that the raw material is composed of collections of individual opinions, attitudes or stereotypes from which the organising principles common to groups of individuals must be pieced together and linked to their psycho-sociological characteristics. One way of making this shift from individual opinions and attitudes to social representations is clustering different patterns of reaction to each variable in a way that transcends the individual level of analysis.

The analysis presented below is based on a large-scale questionnaire survey. The scales included in the questionnaire were various well-established scales in the field of intergroup relations. They were adjusted for their relevance to the Cyprus context after an exploratory qualitative analysis of 18 focus groups. Focus groups were carried out with relatives of missing or victims of the 1963–1964 and 1974 events, displaced people, members of ruling parties, members of opposition, inhabitants of a mixed village, people involved in bi-communal activities, religious people, employers [GCs] and employees [TCs] working in the south and members of nationalist groups. Discussion concerned mainly contact and trust between Greek Cypriots and Turkish Cypriots. Characteristic expressions and

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utterances used by the participants during these focus group discussions will be used in the following analysis to exemplify some of the arguments stemming from the quantitative analysis of the questionnaires.

The large-scale questionnaire survey made use of a representative sample from both communities (N = 800 GCs living south of the buffer zone and N= 853 TCs living north of the buffer zone). The questionnaire studied quantity and quality of contact between TCs and GCs, national identification, trust of lay people of the outgroup, forgiveness, threats (realistic, symbolic, distinctiveness threat), intergroup anxiety (Stephan & Stephan, 1985), perspective taking (Davies, 1994), intergroup salience (Hewstone & Brown, 1986), and attitudes towards the outgroup (Haddock & Zanna, 1998). Of particular importance for the present analysis is the operationalisation of trust and contact and their limitations. Trust was measured with three items: "I can not trust GCs/TCs because they want revenge for things we have done to them in the past", "I trust GCs/TCs when they say that they love Cyprus", "I trust TCs when they say they want peace" (Tam *et al.*, 2009; Psaltis & Hewstone, 2007) using a 5-point Likert scale ranging from 'absolutely disagree' to 'absolutely agree'.

The quantity of contact items was measured in the following conditions: at work, at bi-communal events, at their neighbourhood, in the north and in the south using a 5 point Likert scale ranging from 'not at all' to 'very often'. Finally, the quality of contact with members from the other community was evaluated using the following items: pleasant, superficial, in cooperative spirit, positive, based on mutual respect, feel superior, feel looked down upon. These items were evaluated on a 5-point Likert scale from 'not at all' to 'very much' (Tam *et al.*, 2009; Psaltis & Hewstone, 2007).

From a socio-cultural perspective the use of questionnaires can be criticised on at least two grounds. First, the researcher ascribes specific meanings to trust that might not reflect the participant's reality; second, one can not talk of trust in general because trust always relates to particular others (see Jovchelovitch, 2007a, 2007b). In the present analysis both of these concerns were taken into account. First, the items were adjusted from well-established scales as well as based on focus group discussions of trust. Secondly, the questions of trust and contact specifically referred to members of the outgroup and not to a generalised other.

The discussions in the focus groups revealed a close link between the way GCs and TCs related trust and contact with their affiliation to corresponding historical 'motherlands' Greece and Turkey. As one TC participant, distrustful of the other community, put it: "Why should I meet and collaborate with Greek Cypriots? We have our Turkey and they have their Greece". Indeed previous analyses of identifications in Cyprus and our short historical framework revealed that the role of Greek and Turkish nationalism has been instrumental in creating the Cyprus issue and consolidating separation. Thus measuring the attitude towards 'motherlands' (Greece and Turkey) and the current practice of the use of their symbols (flag, national anthem) was labelled as *Helleno/Turco-centrism* vs *Cypriocentrism* (Peristianis, 1995). The latter was defined as the wish for use of Cypriot national symbols and feelings of detachment from motherlands and was expected to be closely related with trust and contact. Finally, there were questions that explored representations of the history of the Cyprus issue (about 1963–1968 and the nature

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of the Cyprus issue and the participants' view of ethno-nationalist organisations like EOKA and TMT that fought for *enosis* and *taksim* respectively) and the level of acceptance of proposed solutions.

One quantitative technique for the analysis of questionnaires that aims to transcend the limitations of methodological individualism is the two-step cluster analysis (Doise *et al.*, 1993). It is a method that identifies subpopulations in the samples and can base the clustering both on continuous and categorical variables. The use of this method can facilitate the identification of the organising principles that orientate groups of people in each community towards their relationship with the *other*. Although some scales had to be dropped from the analysis due to their low psychometric qualities (Cronbach′s a), most of the scales were entered in the two step-cluster analysis. The vote for a party in the previous parliamentary elections was also included in the analysis as a categorical variable that shows the political marking of identity positions and perspectives on contact and trust.

Once the clusters were identified, further comparisons between them were made on variables relating to past representations and to the acceptability of possible solutions of the Cyprus issue.

Identity positions as perspectives in the GC community

The analysis for the GC community identified three clusters that resonated well with the political and ideological positions of parties in the GC community (see Table 2). In terms of the present quality of intergroup relations, Cluster 1

Table 2 The three clusters identified in the GC community

GC-C1: Pro-reconciliation Critic of ethno-nationalism (33.4% of sample)	*GC-C2: Communitarianism (37.7% of sample)*	*GC-C3: Ethno-nationalism (28.9% of sample)*
Higher: Trust, Contact (quality and quantity), Forgiveness, Perspective taking, Positive feelings	*Lower*: Trust, Contact (quality and quantity), Forgiveness, Perspective taking *Moderate*: Positive feelings	*Lower*: Trust, Contact (quality and quantity), Forgiveness, Perspective taking, Positive feelings
Lower: Threats (Realistic, Distinctiveness), intergroup salience/anxiety	*Higher*: Threats (Realistic, Distinctiveness), intergroup salience/anxiety	*Higher*: Threats (Realistic, Distinctiveness), intergroup salience/anxiety
Identification: 61% more Cypriot than Greek 37% equal weight 2% more Greek than Cypriot	*Identification*: 54% more Cypriot than Greek 43% equal weight 3% more Greek than Cypriot	*Identification*: 14% more Cypriot than Greek 70% equal weight 16% more Greek than Cypriot
High Cypriocentrism Low Hellenocentrism	Moderate Cypriocentrism Moderate Hellenocentrism	Low Cypriocentrism High Hellenocentrism

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(henceforth GC-C1) (representing 32.3% of the sample) showed a very positive orientation towards TCs in terms of trust, quality and quantity of contact, forgiveness, perspective taking, and positive feelings towards TCs. In the same vein, threats (realistic, distinctiveness, intergroup anxiety) were the lowest of the three clusters. Trust, contact, perspective taking and forgiveness were significantly lower in GC-C2 and GC-C3 although GC-C2 occupied the middle ground between GC-C1 and GC-C3 on feelings towards TCs.

Importantly, identification with superordinate or subordinate identities was a distinguishing feature that differentiated GC-C3 from the other two clusters. GC-C1 and GC-C2 are more likely to position themselves as Cypriots than Greeks when asked. GC-C1 describes an identity position that is more likely to feel comfortable being positioned as Cypriot, where Cypriot represents an inclusive of TCs form of civic identity (see Gaertner & Dovidio, 2000). Both positions affiliated with centre and left wing ideologies are associated with the criticism of ethno-nationalism. Ethno-nationalism is viewed as being historically responsible for the creation of the Cyprus problem through the action of right wing paramilitaries in the seventies, agitating for *enosis* (union with Greece) when Cyprus was already an independent state since 1960. However, as can be seen from the high levels of quality and quantity of contact, trust, forgiveness and perspective taking, GC-C1 expresses the perspective of peace activists, bi-communal NGOs, left wing trade unions and a portion of the left wing party that historically kept close links and cooperated with TCs. About one third of this pro-rapprochement cluster would be ready to advocate the creation of a Cypriot nation with its own national symbols as a reaction to the use of the 'motherlands'. A strand of this approach adheres to the ideology of 'neo-cypriots' (see Mavratsas, 1997, 1998, 1999), who aim at promoting an all-inclusive Cypriot national identity for all Cypriots, both GCs and TCs. This position is also critical of the idea that history teaching should aim at the strengthening of Greek national identity. In the other clusters in both communities such criticism is almost absent. This stance relates to a particular representation of the history of Cyprus issue where the conflict of nationalisms (both Greek and Turkish) in 1963–64 and 1967 significantly contributed to the invasion of Cyprus and its partition by Turkey in 1974.

The GC-C2 perspective shows more attachment than GC-C1 to the symbols of Hellenism (flag, national anthem) and resists the idea that Cypriots (GCs and TCs) should start using their own national symbols. This is related to high levels of realistic and distinctiveness threats from TCs, lower levels of trust and the quality and quantity of contact. Being Cypriot in GC-C2 represents an exclusive TCs form of Cypriot national identity that is Greek-Cypriot-centric. Wenzel *et al.*'s (2003) work on ingroup as *pars pro toto* in case of dominant groups seems to capture the dynamic of majorities implicit in this perspective and the promotion of a communitarian GC identity in contra-distinction to the TC identity. It could be argued that this is a form of banal nationalism (Billig, 1995) that involves the unquestioned, common sense presumption that the proper unit of social concern and moral accountability is the nation or state. This may concern economic, legal or ethical accountability of the Republic of Cyprus as a Greek Cypriot run state

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that was formed and functioned after the withdrawal of TCs from the government in 1965. This state is seen as the main weapon of GCs in international politics available to combat the military supremacy of Turkey over GCs. It exists in a competitive relationship with the non-recognised state 'Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus' that attempts to gain international recognition. It is a form of identity that expresses resistance to Turkish occupation while remaining lukewarm towards Turkish Cypriots who can be seen as 'good' if they support the claims of Cypriots as a whole and resist Turkish manipulation of politics in the north. Alternatively, they can be seen as bad and distrustful if they side with Turkey in claiming more from GCs, or gaining leverage in negotiations. Often the phrases like "I do not have a problem with TCs but with Turks. We have lived together with TCs peacefully in the past and we can do it again" are used to explain why feelings towards TCs in GC-C2 occupy the middle ground between GC-C1 and GC-C3.

Despite its adherence to the unity of Cyprus, this position paradoxically leads to the consolidation of partition as it envisions either the maximalist position of returning to a 1960 unified Republic of Cyprus or a Federation with maximum sovereignty to the central government and minimum to the constitutive states. This position seems to threaten and alienate many TCs and leads to hardening of antagonism.

This communitarian/majoritarian position engenders resistance towards the idea of political equality between GCs and TCs in a future federal state. Importantly, from this perspective TCs are seen as not having any agency to solve the Cyprus problem as they believe that the key to a solution is kept by Turkey. Certain representations of the past of the Cyprus issue were found to be significantly differentiating between the three clusters. In the case of GC-C2 in line with this argument, it was found that the history of the Cyprus issue is often depicted as only a problem of invasion by Turkey, which always had an expansionist strategy due to geo-political interests towards Cyprus. Although there is sometimes recognition of the role of conflicting nationalisms leading to conflict and separation on the island, the internal aspect of bi-communal strife is downplayed as just an excuse for Turkey to land troops in Cyprus. Intercommunal conflict is not seen to have contributed to the invasion of Turkey in Cyprus since it is assumed that the invasion would have happened at some point anyway, with or without intercommunal strife taking place.

This position (GC-C2) also expresses a left wing, anti-imperialist, anti-globalisation movement that sees the struggle of self-determination of Cypriots and the salvation from NATO plots and Anglo-American imposition as the major issue to be solved in the future. Such a position is expressing an identity of resistance to the superpowers of the world and distrust to third parties that are involved in the efforts to find a solution to the Cyprus issue (UN, EU, USA and the British) as they are seen to side with Turkey. The only exception is Russia, which is claimed to support GCs on the basis of the principles of international justice. What this left wing position fails to do is to take the perspective of the majority of TCs and support a compromise solution of federation (Trimikliniotis, 2005) to unite

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Cyprus under a federal state. Federalism is sometimes seen as a historical win of the application of NATO plots in Cyprus. From this perspective a unified state with no armies seems to be the ideal solution to the Cyprus issue and not a federation with security guaranteed by foreign countries,.

The identity position or perspective of GC-C3, as can be seen from the identifications and affiliations of the persons with right to extreme right parties, is based on Greek ethno-nationalism. The representation of the past stems from beliefs that the Cyprus issue is the result of Turkish expansionism over Cyprus, and that the 1963–1964 events represented rebellion of Turkish Cypriots against the Republic of Cyprus. The conflict of ethno-nationalist extremist GC paramilitaries was silenced and the economic and political suppression of TCs during the period 1963–1974 was not accorded any notice. According to this position that is also officially propounded by the Greek Orthodox church 'Cyprus is Greek' and it often takes the form of explicit countering of the idea of federation. This suggests that the ideal solution of the Cyprus issue equals just the removal of Turkish troops and return to a unified GC-run state as it functioned from 1965 to 1974. As can be seen from the trust/threat measures in Table 2, that paints a very negative picture; distrust seems to be premised on a heightened sense of racist attitudes of a subtle form (Pettigrew & Meertens, 1995). It is blatantly expressed in the case of extreme right wing organisations as suggested by the high levels of realistic and distinctiveness threats, intergroup anxiety and salience combined with the negative feelings towards TCs, who are often seen as Turks. Greece is seen as the hub of civilisation and Turks as backward. This nationalism is in competition with Turkish nationalism, both seeking to prevail in Cyprus. The feeling of superiority and difference from the Turks leads some to accept complete separation of Cyprus as a realistic option that is based on great distrust in sharing power with TCs. Expressions like, "the only solution is building a wall between us" after territorial adjustments, so that "we have nothing to do with them" are often heard from this stance. So the finding that some GCs in GC-C3 accept the solution of two separate states or of keeping the *status quo* as a solution to the Cyprus issue should come as no surprise.

Identity positions as perspectives in the TC community

The analysis in the TC community also produced three clusters with structural similarities to corresponding GC clusters (see Table 3). Cluster TC-C1in the TC community could be described as the perspective of progressive/liberal left and its entrepreneurs comprising the strong trade unions, bi-communal groups and pro-European NGOs and intellectuals. It also captures a section of the centre–left wing TC party, now in power, that historically kept close links with the GC left wing party which was partly expressed through GC-C1 in the GC community. In fact if we were to run the two-step cluster analysis on the data from both communities, Clusters C1 in both communities would form part of the same trans-communal cluster. In terms of identification, the percentage of relative identification of Cypriot over Turkish identity is significantly higher compared to

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Table 3 The three clusters identified in the TC community

TC-C1: Pro-reconciliation Critic of ethno-nationalism (20% of sample)	*TC-C2: Communitarianism (43% of sample)*	*TC-C3: Ethno-nationalism (37% of sample)*
Higher: Trust, Contact (quality and quantity), Forgiveness, Perspective taking, Positive feelings	*Lower*: Trust, Contact (quantity), Forgiveness, Perspective taking, Positive feelings *Moderate*: Quality of contact	*Lower*: Trust, Contact (quality and quantity), Forgiveness, Perspective taking, Positive feelings
Lower: Threats (Realistic, Distinctiveness), intergroup salience/anxiety	*Higher*: Threats (Realistic, Distinctiveness), intergroup anxiety *Moderate*: Intergroup salience	*Higher*: Threats (Realistic, Distinctiveness), intergroup salience/anxiety
Identification: 25% more Cypriot than Turkish 72 % equal weight 3% more Turkish than Cypriot	*Identification*: 11% more Cypriot than Turkish 71% equal weight 18% more Turkish than Cypriot	*Identification*: 6% more Cypriot than Turkish 68% equal weight 26% more Turkish than Cypriot
Higher Cypriocentrism Lower Turkocentrism	Moderate Cypriocentrism Higher Turkocentrism	Lower Cypriocentrism Higher Turkocentrism

TC-C2 and TC-C3: 25% of the cluster stress their Cypriot identity over Turkish. This Cypriotness for most of them accompanies an anti-ethnonationalist position that would for a small percentage of TCs mean accepting their incorporation in the Republic of Cyprus under proper minority rights in a unified state. However, the majority of this TC-C1cluster (71%) give equal weight to the Turkish and Cypriot component of their identity. The majority of this cluster are thus more likely to feel comfortable being positioned not as Turkish but as Turkish Cypriot (Kibrisli Türk). This perspective represents those who agitate for a form of Turkish Cypriot identity that tries to contest the dominance of Turkish nationalism in the north. At the same time they reject a minority status in regard to both GCs and Turks from Turkey (Ramm, 2004; Lacher & Kaymak, 2005; Vural & Rustemli, 2006). This is the part of TCs that is more sceptical of the continuing import of Turkish immigrants/settlers and pressures from Turkey to be given voting rights by the 'Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus' as a demographic policy to increase the number of Turks in the north. This perspective is Cypriocentric in terms of readiness to accept the use of common symbols (like national flag and anthem) with GCs and the belief that children in school should be taught more about the history of Cyprus than the history of Turkey. This perspective is also critical of the militarisation of the north by Turkish troops and their control of the police, and it supports a federal solution to the Cyprus issue. It is worth noting the low religious feelings of this perspective, since only 20.6% of this cluster consider religion as important. This is a significantly lower percentage than in the other two clusters.

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In TC-C2 the relative identification of Cypriot over Turkish identity is significantly lower compared to TC-C1 but higher compared to TC-C3. It is worth noting that the vast majority give equal weight to the Turkish and Cypriot component (71%), and that only 18% stress the Turkish over the Cypriot component. This perspective expresses a position as Turkish Cypriot that keeps a symbolic distance from GCs and closer affiliation with the symbols of Turkishness, as revealed by high levels of intergroup salience during contact with GCs. This cluster shares structural similarities with GC-C2 of GCs. It is a form of banal nationalism that is premised on the quest for political autonomy of TCs. The great point of tension that orientates their ideological orientation is the loss of political equality and partial control of a recognised state in 1964. It could be argued that this subpopulation is a form of Turkish Cypriot 'state' nationalism, a position that has as an ideal the aim of official recognition of the 'Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus' as a separate state but would also accept a federation that secured maximum autonomy to the TC component state and minimum sovereignty to the federal state. Their closer adherence to religion and closer links with Turkish settlers/immigrants is related with a heightened sense of threats from GCs and lower quantity of contact and trust. However, the quality of contact is at moderate levels between TC-C1 and TC-C3, which reveals that contact can be an opening to change for this perspective. The heightened sense of threats is related with reluctance to agree that they can live together with GCs. This form of state nationalism or communitarianism is in an antagonistic relationship with what they call the 'GC authorities'. This form of communal identity (also seen in the moderate levels of intergroup salience reported, during contact) can be seen to be in a dialectical and antagonistic relationship with the corresponding banal nationalism/communitarianism of GCs (GC-C2). The real antagonism lies between the official claim of GC officials to represent all Cyprus in international fora and the resistance of TCs that claim to have the right to represent themselves, something that is also denied to them by international law. Representations of the past of the Cyprus issue are again found to legitimise certain ideological orientations. Whilst for the TC-C1 perspective the Cyprus problem is often considered as a problem of foreign interventions, TMT is recognised both as a resistance organisation with respect to GSs and also as a nationalist organisation. In the case of TC-C2 the bi-communal strife gets more emphasis and TMT takes the high moral ground as it is presented only as a resistance organisation. In TC-C3, as we see below, the memory is even more selective and monoperspectival since the Cyprus problem is considered as a problem of Greek expansionism. The conflicts of 1963 are seen as one-sided aggressiveness of GCs against TCs and TMT is seen as a resistance organisation without any nationalist agenda.

The perspective identified in Cluster 3 expresses a more Turcocentric point of view and again is the mirror image of GC ethno-nationalism in its Turkish version (Ozkirimli & Sophos, 2008; Papadakis, 2008) as a continuation of the historical claim for *taksim* (partition). In terms of identification and quality of relations with GCs, this is a cluster that resembles TC-C2 to a great extent but the difference in political origins of the two clusters (TC-C1 and TC-C3) suggests that they might

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be drawing on different sources for their identification as mainly Turkish Cypriots. One is naturally the traditional Turkish ethno-nationalism of TMT that saw Cyprus as Turkish and the other is based on more recent political ideological constructions. In 1996, politicians of a right wing party that supports the recognition of 'Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus', in a manifesto for identity proposed the idea of a 'Cypriot Turkish nationalism' (Ramm, 2004), based on the state in the north. In the words of the manifesto, "Our approach is to include all our people in a TRNC consciousness, to embrace every Turk with a TRNC citizenship bonds, wherever he was born, whenever and whatever place of the world he came, as a Cypriot Turk" (Bizden, 1997, cited in Ramm, 2004). The same goes with adherence to religious values since 61.2% of this cluster considers religion as important.

Social representations and history

The analysis presented here should have made clear that trust sustains and is sustained by processes of valorisation that extend over the past–present and future. They both have a central role in the organisation of acting and thinking in relation to events of social rupture and transition (Zittoun *et al.*, 2003), such as, for example, the recent case of the opening of the checkpoints in Cyprus, which opened up opportunities for intergroup contact. It is expected that the representations of the 23 April 2003 opening of a few checkpoints would be anchored in ways that offer legitimisation and establish continuity with these positions identified in the previous sections (cf. Demetriou, 2006, 2007; Webster, 2005). Representations of the opening of the checkpoints are in turn firmly rooted in particular representations of the history of Cyprus. Indeed, further analyses revealed that the majority of the pro-reconciliation groups in both communities (70.3% of GCs and 75.2% of TCs) saw the opening of the checkpoints as an opportunity for the development of better bi-communal relations in a spirit of furthering trust and would disagree with the idea that the checkpoints should close. From this perspective contact seems to be of great importance for the improvement of bi-communal relations and not just for the achievement of personal goals (cf. Van Dick *et al.*, 2004). However, the majority of the rest of the clusters were negative in terms of how the participants saw the opening of the checkpoints. They thought that they created an opportunity for the increase of crime, losing jobs, normalisation of segregation in the case of GCs or fear of assimilation and losing in trade competitiveness in the case of TCs.

This analysis makes visible some aspects of contact in relation to trust that have become obscured in the contact hypothesis literature and also in more recent approaches based on the seminal work of Allport (1954). Allport's original identification of support by law and custom of contact as a necessary condition might have indeed showed some sensitivity to the issue of social representations *of contact* than just contact *per se* but this has never been fully explored. The present approach, which examines varieties of positions in both communities, exemplifies the interdependence of *subject–object–other* in the genetic process and points to the need to conceptualise contact as a microgenetic process of social interaction

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the impact of which, on the reduction of prejudice, can be moderated by the position/perspective held by both the subject and the other. More importantly, it points to the need to examine the joint effects of the position of the interactants on the way they co-construct new knowledge and feelings in every contact as they relate to ontogenetic and sociogenetic change. This brings into sharp relief the need to recover complexity and to articulate different levels of analysis (Doise, 1986; cf. Forbes, 1997) when studying intergroup contact.

This study shows how contact, both its quantity and quality, is vulnerable to representations of the importance of contact as it relates to political ideologies and the past and future of the Cyprus issue. Ontogenetic change of such social representations can of course take place through contact itself since microgenesis is the motor of ontogenesis, but the effort should also aim at achieving sociogenetic change through collective action and institutionalisation (Duveen & Lloyd, 1990). To better understand microgenesis in contact, the field will need to turn to observational methods that combine ethnographic observations with experimental designs, what we might call experimental ethnography (see Psaltis, 2005a) from the perspective of both interlocutors in social interaction.

The media and the educational system play a major role in leading sociogenetic change of trust or distrust as they strengthen or weaken legitimising myths that sustain inequalities (cf. Sidanius & Pratto, 2001) or conflict. These ideological apparatuses can be seen as constraining and enabling the use of symbolic elements of the past as symbolic resources that make possible the transition from past and present to the future in the effort to make the unfamiliar familiar (Zittoun *et al.*, 2003).

A future research programme that will study contact from a social representations perspective will need to revisit Moscovici's (1961) seminal work on psychoanalysis and forms of communication (diffusion, propagation, propaganda) and their relation to opinions, attitudes and stereotypes as well as the way they relate to behaviour towards the outgroup. It will also have to engage the literature on minority influence in relation to social interaction and its role in development (Piaget, 1932/1965, 1977/1995; Psaltis, 2005b, 2007). In addition, it could examine how minorities can potentially change the social representations of contact in a post-conflict society.

Until recently, for example, in Cyprus the media and education were orientated towards forms of communication that Moscovici (1961)would have identified as propaganda of the official version aiming at the promotion of a hegemonic social representation that closes down dialogue with internal and external others (Duveen, 2002, 2007). The problem is really acute when it comes to the teaching of history in schools in Cyprus where the other's perspective on the Cyprus problem is suppressed. The nationalistic premise on which it is structured (see Makriyianni, 2006; Makriyianni & Psaltis, 2007; Papadakis, 2008) promotes representations of the past that are homogeneous, affective, and impermeable to experience or contradiction. This leaves little scope for individual variation and is therefore similar to the 'dogma' of religion. By contrast, history teaching should be more fluid, pragmatic and amenable to the proof of success or failure. It should

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leave a certain latitude to language, experience and even to the critical features of individuals (Makriyianni & Psaltis, 2007). The attempt of the media and education to promote only a monoperspectival official narrative has been a great hindrance in the efforts to create trust between the two communities. In fact, suppressing the others' pain and presenting a monoperspective view of history resulted, as can be seen in the present research, in the domination of C2 and C3 perspectives on the Cyprus issue, across the divide. This has consolidated the partition of the two communities by suffocating actual contact between people and its importance, even if at times this might not actually be the intended consequence (Psaltis, 2007). These perspectives that thrive either on ethno-nationalist perspectives (C3) or on the antagonism and avoid or gain official recognition of the state in the north (C2) have become mirror images of themselves that in a dialectical sense feed each other. Such positions are strengthened by certain political parties in the GC community who asked GCs not to cross to the north so as not to give 'indirect recognition' to the self-declared state. Such a discourse provided symbolic resources (Zittoun *et al.*, 2003, 2007) that first 'moralised' (Demetriou, 2006, 2007) the crossings and also 'instrumentalised' crossings as part of a Machiavellian strategy by the TC leadership and Turkey to extract recognition of the north by GCs. The moralisation and instrumentalisation discourse was clearly articulated in different forms by GCs in our focus group discussions: "I do not cross because I do not want to support the economy of the pseudo-state", "I will not visit my home as a tourist", "I will not cross because producing ID to cross means I am recognising them". All these reasons point to a basic distrust that crossings and even contact could lead to partition becoming normalised, which is the major fear of the vast majority of GCs. Finally, this analysis reveals how geographical separation and lack of contact can consolidate antagonism and distrust, since negative social representations of contact based on distrust can diminish the possibilities for contact itself and its perceived importance (cf. Van Dick *et al.*, 2004).

A new definition of intergroup trust can be attempted on the basis of the present results that clarifies its relation to contact and other concepts traditionally studied in the field of intergroup relations. Intergroup trust is a relational process that can be described at four levels. It involves the readiness to think about both self and other perspective on the basis of mutual respect without an a priori exclusion of the possibility of their coordination. Such readiness can be enacted through non-reflective forms in contact/social interaction or reflective forms as evaluations or representations of intergroup contact usually as cooperative, positive, pleasant and based on mutual respect in a spirit of acknowledgement of its value in the promotion of cooperative intergroup relations and the absence of realistic or symbolic threats (Gillespie, 2007). Trust can be considered a facilitative condition of microgenetic, ontogenetic and sociogenetic change of every social representation as it regulates/moderates the resolution of socio-cognitive conflict that emerges in social interaction with the other and otherness itself. It regulates the strength attached to one's positions and openness or resistance to change, in other words, the identity of a person (Duveen, 2001).

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Notes

1 EOKA-B was a Greek Cypriot paramilitary organization formed in 1971. It followed a right-wing nationalistic ideology and had the ultimate goal of achieving the *enosis* (union) of Cyprus with Greece. It was actively involved in the implementation of the coup d'état attempt against the president Makarios in 1974.
2 Certain areas, like the city of Varoshia for example, are still closed to the public by the Turkish military.
3 For a discussion of the results of the referendum see Bahceli (2004) and Coufoudakis (2004).

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